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# INDIAN SCI-FI TV SHOWS

Kids who grew up in the 80s and 90s will remember these shows on DD and the early days of cable networks.

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While there are many fantasy TV shows, there are not too many Science Fiction shows that are made in India. The few that have been made were made during the early days of special effects and computer graphics, and aimed towards children as they were the audience that was most attracted to the kind of content. The CGI is very basic in all these shows, and old school tricks such as puppetry and make up are used liberally. A futuristic setting also served as a learning experience, and acted as a platform for presenting scientific concepts and ideas on what the future of technology could look like. As such, most of these shows are dated, and are a healthy dose of nostalgia. None of the shows are currently on air, and are not available on streaming services also, for the most part. However, you may be able to catch these shows from a good DVD library in your city.


**SPACE CITY SIGMA**

Space City Sigma was produced by DoorDarshan and started airing in 1989. Visually, the series was strikingly similar to Star Trek. The main characters

are the captain of the base Tara, his subordinate Shakti who is a cyborg, and Heeri who is the communications officer. The crew of the Space City Sigma had handheld energy weapons, and yes, it was possible to set them on stun. Space City Sigma is a space outpost for the human civilisation in the future, where humans are holding out against a technologically advanced race led by an evil mastermind known as Zhakha-Koo, who is trying to conquer humans and add them to his galactic kingdom. Every episode is a clear cut fight between the good humans, and the bad aliens. At times, there are other alien species that attack the space station. The series also has time travel, robotic hive minds, cloning, artificial intelligence, memory wiping machines and other concepts that were way ahead of its time.


**CAPTAIN VYOM**

At a time when school textbooks still said that the Solar System had nine planets, Captain Vyom informed young children that there were eleven,

which was the most up to date information available at that time. The descriptions of the planets and moons are accurate, and there are many references to concepts of famous scientists. Captain Vyom is set in the far future, where the world government is based out of Delhi. They have in their custody, on the Jovian moon Io, 12 of the biggest super villains in the universe, who have superpowers such as the ability to control gravity, change the form of living creatures, the power of alchemy, or even freely travel back and forwards through time. An asteroid impact combined with a mysterious alien help all these supervillains escape, and it is up to our hero, Captain Vyom to round them all up and recapture them. The entire series is available on the Wow Teenz channel on YouTube.


**BADI DOOOOOR SE AAYE HAI**

The series follows a family of aliens who crash land into the Earth while on the search for their missing son. While in their home

planet, their names are based on numbers and equations, on the Earth, they adopt the name of "Ghotala". They try to fit in with their new surroundings, keep a low profile to prevent their

discovery by the humans, as the family is scared that they will be captured by scientists. Most of the comedy of the show stems from a very interesting angle, that while the Ghotala family are aliens to us, the humans on Earth are equally alien to them. They do not understand a lot of things about our behavior and culture. Eventually, the Ghotalas get friendly with their human neighbours, and even save the planet from other evil alien beings using their advanced powers. Eventually, the family manages to retrieve their son and are going back, when the son reveals that he has a child on Earth.